

RACHEL SCHNEIDER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Master's-trained policy researcher with seven years of combined professional, academic, and community-based experience spanning policy and legal research, administration, records management, program coordination, and stakeholder communication. Author of a multi-jurisdictional regional policy report for the Alliance to End Homelessness in the Capital Region. Active community leader currently serving on the board of Project Reconnect and as Chair of the Youth Committee at the Rotary Club of Victoria Harbourside. Comfortable working independently and as part of cross-functional teams in fast-paced, public-facing environments.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Chair, Youth Committee (Rotary Youth Exchange Program)

April 2026 – Present

Rotary Club of Victoria Harbourside | Victoria, BC

- Coordinate the Rotary Youth Exchange program at the club level, overseeing both inbound students hosted in Victoria and outbound students placed with partner clubs internationally.
- Screen and select host families through written applications, criminal background checks, personal interviews, and home visits in accordance with Rotary Youth Protection standards.
- Serve as the primary point of contact for host families, sending families, exchange students, and partner clubs, providing ongoing support, problem resolution, and program guidance.
- Source household items for host families; oversee insurance, documentation, and pre-departure preparation for outbound students.
- Chair monthly committee meetings, set agendas, and document decisions and follow-up actions.
- Liaise with the Rotary District 5020 Youth Exchange Committee on program compliance, training requirements, and reporting.

Board Member & Project Coordinator

August 2025 – Present

Project Reconnect | Victoria, BC

- Contribute to board governance and event planning for Project Reconnect, an annual community service event connecting hundreds of unhoused and precariously housed individuals with local support services (approximately 350 participants served in 2025).
- Collaborate with board members and community partners to coordinate sponsorships and fundraising.
- Developed a comprehensive volunteer handbook outlining volunteer roles, event logistics, safety procedures, contact information, and a venue map.
- Assist with volunteer recruitment, scheduling, and on-site coordination and communications.

Rotarian

September 2024 – Present

Rotary Club of Victoria Harbourside | Victoria, BC

- Serve on the International Services Committee, reviewing and approving international charity grant applications and supporting global service initiatives.
- Provide monthly logistical support for grocery deliveries to seniors experiencing food insecurity.
- Support club fundraising, grant writing, and community engagement events, contributing to event logistics and volunteer coordination.

- Recognized at the year-end celebration for outstanding volunteerism and contributions as a new club member.

Community Projects & Research Assistant

November 2024 – August 2025

Alliance to End Homelessness in the Capital Region (AEHCR) | Victoria, BC

- Researched and authored the Regional Overview of Permitted Sheltering, a 60-page policy report examining the legal and regulatory frameworks governing temporary overnight sheltering in public spaces across 13 municipalities and 3 electoral areas of the Capital Regional District.
- Analyzed and synthesized federal, provincial, and municipal legislation—including the BC Park Act, Motor Vehicle Act, Forest and Range Practices Act, and federal Controlled Access Zone Order—and relevant case law (*Victoria (City) v. Adams*, *Saanich (District) v. Brett*).
- Supported the Seniors Advisory Committee project, identifying senior-serving spaces and contributing to work on elder abuse, isolation, and housing insecurity.
- Coordinated and supported committee meetings, including agenda preparation, minute-taking, and follow-up tracking.

Administrative Assistant and Legal Aid

November 2018 – August 2019

Higgerty Law | Calgary, AB

- Managed the principal attorney's schedule and case calendar through proactive communication and diligent coordination.
- Directed client intake, correspondence, and scheduling, ensuring accuracy and confidentiality of sensitive case information.
- Designed and implemented a digital archiving system, converting and indexing hundreds of case files into a keyword-coded, searchable database; reorganized physical archives for long-term accessibility.
- Prepared and maintained legal documentation, coordinated filings, and supported day-to-day office operations with close attention to detail.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Server

June 2023 – Present

Irish Times Pub | Victoria, BC

- Provide high-quality customer service in one of Victoria's busiest pubs, managing multiple tables in a fast-paced, high-volume environment.
- Strengthened core skills in communication, multitasking, and adapting to shifting priorities under time pressure.
- Recognized by coworkers, managers, and patrons for professionalism, attention to detail, and a positive, capable demeanour.

Teaching Assistant Consultant (TAC)

September 2020 – August 2021

University of Victoria – Learning and Teaching Support and Innovation | Victoria, BC

- Delivered over eight hours of customized, discipline-specific workshops for graduate teaching assistants.
- Provided one-on-one mentorship and academic support to 17 graduate teaching assistants.
- Designed and facilitated seminars based on adult-learning principles and detailed instructional planning.
- Collaborated with university staff to assess TA training needs and adapt programming accordingly.

- Authored a year-end report summarizing program outcomes, participant feedback, and recommendations for future TACs.

Founder & Coach

September 2013 – July 2018

Eric Hamber Debate Club | Vancouver, BC

- Founded and managed a successful debate club for five years, overseeing operations, logistics, and outreach.
- Organized interschool debate tournaments, securing school facilities, managing budgets, and coordinating food services, volunteers, and judges.
- Successfully applied for a program grant from the Debate and Speech BC foundation.
- Built strong working relationships with teachers, parents, and students, fostering significant skill development in debaters.
- Mentored high school students in critical thinking, public speaking, and research, contributing to the team's competitive success.

EDUCATION

Master of Arts, History

2019 – 2023

University of Victoria | Victoria, BC

Thesis: Black Perspectives on American Imperial Expansion, 1898–1902. Concentration in Cultural, Social and Political Thought (CSPT).

Bachelor of Arts, International Relations

2013 – 2017

University of British Columbia | Vancouver, BC

Graduated with Class I standing.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & CERTIFICATIONS

- Rotary Leadership Institute – Leadership Certificate (2025)
- Teaching Assistant Consultant Training – Learning and Teaching Support and Innovation, University of Victoria (2020)

LANGUAGES

- English – native
- French – advance